Client Database v15 – Summary

Client Database v15 is a JSON-backed, authoritative client reference layer designed to integrate seamlessly with the existing v13 mapping logic without introducing breaking changes. It centralises client identity, validation rules, mappings, and notification settings while preserving v13's inference behaviour as a safe fallback.

The database acts as the single source of truth for canonical Client IDs, Client Names, aliases, and per-client configuration. Spreadsheets are not required to contain a Client ID; the resolver can identify clients using spreadsheet names, inferred names, or filenames.

Core Capabilities

Safe Client Resolution
• Resolves client identity using a strict priority order: inferred Client ID, exact name, alias, conservative fuzzy match, then fallback inference
• Never auto-creates new clients or IDs during processing

Backward Compatibility by Design
• Fully compatible with v13 workflows
• Falls back cleanly to v13 inference when no safe database match exists

Robust & Deterministic Matching
• Normalised name matching (case, spacing, punctuation agnostic)
• Conservative fuzzy matching with confidence scoring and ambiguity protection
• Full audit metadata returned with each resolution

Structured Client Configuration
• Client name aliases
• Excess rules (allowed values and defaults)
• Cover level and cover type validation rules
• Header candidates and value mappings
• Email notification recipients (To / CC)
• Supports both legacy and preferred schemas for gradual migration

Controlled Client ID Management
• Product-based ID prefixes (GA / TR / PA)
• Sequential and persistent ID generation
• Intended for GUI or admin workflows only

Operational Safety
• Atomic JSON read/write operations
• No destructive behaviour during automated processing
• Explicit confidence and source reporting for every resolution

Intended Usage
• Plug-in layer for mapping, validation, and notification logic
• Enables progressive migration to fully controlled client configuration
• Provides a foundation for future GUI administration and auditing